

Rooted FC: How Trees Help Rainwater Score



THE AIM

Get the rain into the ground, where it can feed soil, plants, streams and springs later.

THE DANGER

On bare compacted ground, rain runs off the pitch before it gets a chance to score.

Team Sheet

Leaves United

Leaves defend against the attack of raindrops and stop the soil being smashed into a hard crust.

Stem City

Stems and trunks control midfield, slowing the match down and guiding water safely towards the ground.

Root Madrid

Roots attack the soil, opening channels and creating the scoring chances for water to go underground.

Worms Albion

Worms, fungi, insects and microbes coach from below, building tunnels and helping the whole team play better.

Soil Trafford

Healthy soil is the goalmouth. A good goal holds water after the match and releases it slowly later.

Runoff Rovers

Bare compacted ground loses possession. Water races downhill, carries soil away, and leaves the pitch.

Humans Are the Manager

The manager cannot kick every ball. Their job is to choose the team shape: where to plant, where to protect young trees, where to keep animals off while roots grow, and where to watch what happens after rain.

Field Challenge

Stand on a slope after rain and ask:

- Where is water running away fastest?
- Where is the ground bare, hard or compacted?
- Where are trees, roots or rough grass already slowing water down?
- Where would you put your next defender?

**Rain is the ball. Leaves defend. Roots attack. Soil is the goal.
Humans manage the team.**

Bonus Idea: 60-Second Commentary Script

1. **Rain attacks:** "Here comes the rain, and it's attacking fast down the hillside!"
2. **Bare ground struggles:** "Oh no, Runoff Rovers are breaking through! The soil has no defence, and the water is racing off the pitch!"
3. **Leaves defend:** "But wait, here come Leaves United! Brilliant defending! They slow down the raindrops and stop them smashing the soil into a hard crust."
4. **Stems control midfield:** "Stem City take control, calming the play and guiding the water safely down."
5. **Roots score:** "Now Root Madrid are on the attack! They open up the soil, create space, and there it is: water scores underground!"
6. **Soil life coaches:** "And don't forget the coaching staff: worms, fungi and soil life, building the tunnels that make the whole team better."
7. **Humans manage:** "Humans are the manager. We choose where to plant, where to protect young trees, and where to watch after the rain."
8. **Final score:** "Rooted FC one, Runoff Rovers nil!"